Endocrinology Service Line Handbook

MERIDIAN HEALTH PARTNERS ## Department of Endocrinology — Service Line Handbook Document ID: MHP-END-SOP-442 Effective Date: 14 January 2025 Owner: Dr. Aris Thorne, Chief of Endocrinology / Operations Policy Lead

1. Purpose and Scope 1.1 This handbook establishes the operational parameters, service limitations, scheduling standards, and insurance coverage matrices for the Endocrinology Department across all 14 Meridian Health Partners outpatient sites. 1.2 Compliance with this policy is mandatory for all clinical, administrative, and patient access personnel.

2. Clinical Scope: Conditions Accepted and Explicitly Not Accepted 2.1 Accepted Conditions: The department accepts adult outpatient referrals for: * Primary and secondary diabetes mellitus (Type 1 and Type 2) * Thyroid disorders (hypothyroidism, hyperthyroidism, thyroid nodules, and thyroiditis) * Parathyroid and calcium metabolism disorders * Adrenal insufficiency and incidentalomas * Pituitary disorders (non-functioning adenomas and hyperpituitarism)

2.2 Explicitly Not Accepted Conditions: The department does not accept referrals for:
* Pediatric endocrinology patients under the age of 18 years
* Bariatric surgical management or primary weight-loss programs without an underlying endocrine pathology
* Acute inpatient endocrinological emergencies (such as diabetic ketoacidosis or thyroid storm)
* Gender-affirming hormone therapy initiation (managed exclusively by the Department of Primary Care and Internal Medicine)

3. Appointment Durations and Access Commitments 3.1 Individual service line appointments operate within a duration range of 15 to 30 minutes. 3.2 The Department of Endocrinology commits to offering a first appointment to any patient with an accepted referral within 12 calendar days of referral receipt. 3.3 Referral processing and intake turnaround times are governed strictly by the corporate Referral Management Policy (MHP-ADM-SOP-102); local department variations are prohibited.

4. Patient Preparation Instructions 4.1 Fasting Requirements: Patients scheduled for blood glucose panels or combined metabolic assessments must observe a strict 8-hour overnight fast prior to arrival. Water is permitted. 4.2 Medication Protocols: Patients undergoing thyroid fine-needle aspiration must withhold therapeutic anticoagulant therapy for 5 calendar days prior to the procedure, subject to written clearance from their prescribing physician. 4.3 Documentation: Patients must bring all home glucose logs covering the preceding 14 calendar days, alongside current physical medication bottles or an updated pharmacy printout, to every initial and follow-up consultation.

5. Procedure Codes, List Prices, Durations, and Plan Coverage Matrix 5.1 The four accepted Meridian health plans apply the following coverage rules, list prices, appointment durations, and pre-authorisation timelines to department service codes:

* ENDO-CONS: Endocrinology Consultation
* *Description:* Standard clinical consultation
* *List Price:* $190
* *Duration:* 30 minutes
* *Plan Coverage & Pre-Authorisation:*
* MERIDIAN-GOLD: Covered, no pre-authorisation required.
* MERIDIAN-SILVER: Covered, no pre-authorisation required.
* MERIDIAN-BRONZE: Covered, no pre-authorisation required.
* CIVIC-BASE: Covered, no pre-authorisation required.

* ENDO-PANL: Thyroid Function Panel
* *Description:* Diagnostic laboratory panel
* *List Price:* $140
* *Duration:* 15 minutes
* *Plan Coverage & Pre-Authorisation:*
* MERIDIAN-GOLD: Covered, no pre-authorisation required.
* MERIDIAN-SILVER: Covered, no pre-authorisation required.
* MERIDIAN-BRONZE: Covered, no pre-authorisation required.
* CIVIC-BASE: Covered, no pre-authorisation required.

* ENDO-FNAB: Thyroid Fine-Needle Aspiration
* *Description:* Interventional diagnostic procedure
* *List Price:* $900
* *Duration:* 30 minutes
* *Plan Coverage & Pre-Authorisation:*
* MERIDIAN-GOLD: Covered, pre-authorisation required in 2 business days.
* MERIDIAN-SILVER: Covered, pre-authorisation required in 3 business days.
* MERIDIAN-BRONZE: Covered, pre-authorisation required in 5 business days.
* CIVIC-BASE: Covered, pre-authorisation required in 7 business days.

6. Administrative Exceptions 6.1 No clinical provider, practice manager, or site supervisor has the authority to waive pre-authorisation timelines or modify list prices established in Section 5. 6.2 Any emergency override requests for procedure ENDO-FNAB must be submitted via the urgent clinical review portal and signed off by the Chief of Endocrinology.